

DEMO.CEP.REC.31/13.01.013/2025-26

Framework for Customer Grievance Redressal

In exercise of the powers conferred under the applicable statute, the following directions are issued. These directions shall come into force with immediate effect and shall supersede earlier instructions on the subject to the extent that they are inconsistent.

1. Internal ombudsman

Every regulated entity having more than ten banking outlets shall appoint an internal ombudsman. The internal ombudsman shall be a retired or serving officer not below the rank of deputy general manager, and shall not have been employed by the appointing entity in the preceding two years.

2. Reference of complaints

All complaints that are proposed to be rejected in whole or in part shall be referred to the internal ombudsman before the decision is communicated to the complainant. Complaints relating to fraud, forgery and matters pending before a court are excluded from this requirement.

3. Time limit

The internal ombudsman shall decide a reference within twenty one days. Where the recommendation of the internal ombudsman is not accepted by the regulated entity, approval of an officer of the rank of executive director or above shall be obtained.

4. Acknowledgement of complaints

Every complaint shall be acknowledged within three working days of receipt, and shall be assigned a unique complaint identification number which shall be communicated to the complainant.

5. Resolution timeline

A complaint shall be resolved within thirty days of receipt. Where a complaint requires investigation involving a third party, the complainant shall be informed of the expected timeline before the expiry of thirty days.

6. Root cause analysis

The regulated entity shall carry out a root cause analysis of complaints on a quarterly basis, and shall place the analysis before the customer service committee of the board.

7. Display of information

The name, address and contact particulars of the ombudsman having jurisdiction shall be displayed prominently at every banking outlet and on the website and mobile application of the regulated entity.